

2023 HSC English Standard — Paper 1

Marking Guidelines

Section I

Question 1

Criteria	Marks
Explains effectively how Greenacre represents the value of shared experiences using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Explains how Greenacre represents the value of shared experiences using some supporting evidence	3
Describes how Greenacre represents the value of shared experiences using limited supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about the text	1

Sample answer:

Greenacre represents the value of shared experiences through the ritual of making tea that keeps this family close. The symbolic ‘tea leaves tin’ is central to the family’s shared moments and ‘held pride of place/in the running of the house’. The speaker’s nostalgic tone highlights the value of shared time as a family, ‘and I can still see them all / waiting around the table’. Greenacre suggests that objects provide a tangible link to shared family experiences across time: ‘this, of all things drew our family together, by cup, by spoon’ reinforcing the lasting value of family connection.

Question 2

Criteria	Marks
Explains skilfully how Dahl uses personal experience to show the reader the importance of kindness using detailed, well-chosen supporting evidence	5
Explains effectively how Dahl uses personal experience to show the reader the importance of kindness using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Explains how Dahl uses personal experience to show the reader the importance of kindness using some supporting evidence	3
Describes how Dahl uses personal experience to show the reader the importance of kindness	2
Provides some relevant information about the text	1

Sample answer:

Dahl shows the reader the importance of kindness through her personal experience of being welcomed by others. Dahl's use of anecdotes throughout the article, such as 'When I was three years old, I experienced the definition of welcome' and 'As a furious, spiky 16-year-old' emphasises how her memories of being welcomed have stayed with her. The reader is shown the positive impact of welcoming others, as the negative experience of 'being left out in the cold' is contrasted to 'That lovely mother melted me back down to my original form, just by being kind'. This contrasting imagery reminds the reader of their own memories of welcome and the value of kindness.

Question 3

Criteria	Marks
Demonstrates an effective understanding of why Dank prefers 'that gravel and dust comfort, away from that other place' using well-chosen supporting evidence	3
Demonstrates an understanding of why Dank prefers 'that gravel and dust comfort, away from that other place' using appropriate evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about the extract	1

Sample answer:

Dank prefers the familiarity of 'that gravel and dust comfort' because it represents the fulfilment of home. In contrast, the 'strange new pressure of wet pebbles' and 'velvety, texture' of ocean sand is confronting and 'foreign' to the 'dry, dusty earth' to which she feels a deep connection. Dank's inability to find the same 'comfort' and connection at the beach is evident as the 'sand and shells and seaweed remained just what they were ... There was no story talking to my bones'. The contrasting feeling of the 'sharp edges of the gravel and soft dust' is where Dank feels grounded, providing a comforting and enriching 'way into new stories' that is soul-affirming.

Question 4

Criteria	Marks
Analyses effectively Langbroek's representation of the emotional impact of new places using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Analyses Langbroek's representation of the emotional impact of new places using appropriate supporting evidence	3
Explains Langbroek's representation of the emotional impact of new places with some supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about Langbroek's representation of the emotional impact of new places	1

Sample answer:

Langbroek reveals the positive emotional impact of exploring new places by comparing this with the experience of falling in love. The reader is immersed in Langbroek's experience through the use of a personal, reflective tone and inclusive language: we don't know how a country will 'open up to us, and us to it'. The metaphorical relationship is established through positive, vivid images of life in Italy: 'glittering seas' and 'golden light' which she associates with 'falling in love'. Langbroek evokes an emotional response from the reader as we find familiarity and inclusion in the experience of new places and the feeling of love through the use of second person narration: 'You feel alive ... You are open and happy and free ... You laugh ...'.

Question 5

Criteria	Marks
Explains skilfully how Hamblin expands the reader's understanding of the paradoxes of consumerism using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Explains effectively how Hamblin expands the reader's understanding of the paradoxes of consumerism using appropriate supporting evidence	3
Explains how Hamblin expands the reader's understanding of the paradoxes of consumerism with some supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about how Hamblin expands our understanding of the paradoxes of consumerism	1

Sample answer:

Hamblin expands the reader's understanding of the paradoxes of consumerism by showing that 'we stop appreciating things ... They deteriorate or become obsolete'. Paradoxically, we usually think that material goods bring happiness but the connection from 'trips, concerts, movies ... tend to trump material purchases' and provide 'more enduring happiness'. The adjective 'enduring' suggests that experiential purchases form memories that connect us. The direct address 'when you can't live in a moment ... live in anticipation of an experience' and inclusive language 'our memories and stories ... get sweeter' invites the reader to share Hamblin's perspective on the paradoxical nature of consumerism.

Section II

Question 6

Criteria	Marks
- Evaluates skilfully the extent to which the prescribed text ignites ideas about collective human experiences that enrich our view of the world - Presents an insightful response supported by well-chosen textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a coherent and sustained response using language appropriate for audience, purpose and context	17–20
- Evaluates effectively the extent to which the prescribed text ignites ideas about collective human experiences that enrich our view of the world - Presents a thoughtful response supported by relevant textual references from the prescribed text - Writes an organised response using language appropriate for audience, purpose and context	13–16
- Explains the extent to which the prescribed text ignites ideas about collective human experiences that enrich our view of the world - Presents a response supported by some textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a response using variable control of language appropriate for audience and purpose	9–12
- Expresses limited understanding of the extent to which the prescribed text ignites ideas about collective human experiences that enrich our view of the world - Describes aspects of the prescribed text - Writes a response with minimal control of language	5–8
- Refers to the prescribed text in a minimal way - Attempts to compose a response	1–4

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Mapping Grid

Section I

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
1	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-2, EN12-3
2	5	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3, EN12-5
3	3	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3
4	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-4, EN12-5
5	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-5, EN12-8

Section II

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
6	20	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences – Prose Fiction – Poetry – Drama – Nonfiction – Film – Media	EN12-1, EN12-5, EN12-7